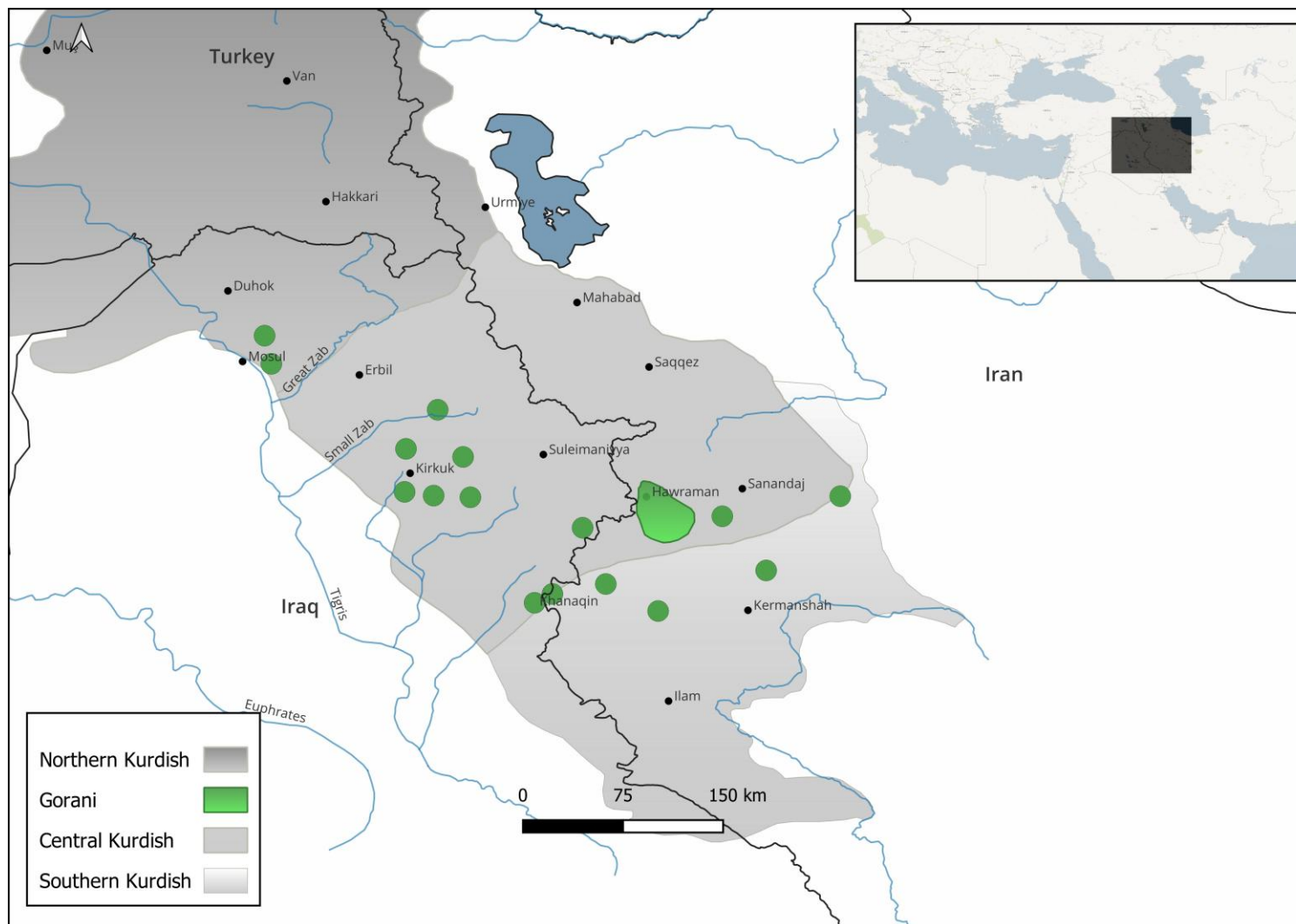


The Gorani substrate in Southern Central Kurdish dialects

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MacKenzie (1961a):

The northern variety of Kurdish preserved its “purity”, while the variety which converged with Gorani, i.e., CK, became less conservative. The resulting CK variety later overtook Gorani entirely, except for small pockets of existing Gorani dialects within the sea of Kurdish.

Table 1: Some linguistic features distinguishing between CK and NK¹

	Feature	Gorani	SK/CK	NK
i	person clitics	+	+	-
ii	a definite suffix <i>-eke</i>	+	+	-
iii	morphological passive	+	+	-
iv	open NP-compounds ²	+	+	-
v	telic particle <i>-ewe</i> ³	post-verb	post-verb	pre-verb

Data and sources

Takht dialect of Hawrami (14 narratives, Mohammadirad *in prep*)

Central Kurdish of Sanandaj region (11 narratives, Mohammadirad 2021)

<https://multicast.aspra.uni-bamberg.de/resources/wowa/>

Central Kurdish of Shaqlawa (6 narratives, Khan et al. 2022)

Mukri Central Kurdish (Öpengin 2016)

Data and sources



Filedwork in Hawraman Takht, August 2022

Linguistic history of the region

- À Sänä où le kurde est maintenant la langue commune hors des communautés persane, juive et syrienne, on prétendait que l'awromānī y avait été communément entendu autrefois [In Sänä [Sanandaj, K. Sine], where Kurdish is now the common language outside the Persian, Jewish and Syriac communities, it was claimed that Awromānī had been commonly heard there in the past] (Christensen and Benedictsen 1921)

Linguistic history of the region

A more concrete account of language shift in Sanandaj is found in the introduction to a translation of Bible in Gorani (or Hawrami) in Kurdistānī (1930). The author was a famous physician from Sanandaj named Dr. Sa'eed Khan Kordestani (1863-1943). He reports on his return to his hometown Sanandaj after 50 years, and laments that **“Hawrami, the original 'sweet' dialect of the city, is now completely extinct and can be seen spoken only by a handful of old women in the corners and alleyways of Sanandaj.”**

Linguistic history of the region

- Mahmoudveysi (2016, 3) reports that speakers of Bēwānījī, Rijābī, and Gāhwārāī localities in around Kerend (Iran), which were investigated by Mann and Hadank (1930) as Gorani dialects, have now shifted to vernaculars of Southern Kurdish.
- Leezenberg (1992) reports the shift from Gorani to Kurdish in part of Iraqi Kurdistan in the last 120 years ago [now 150]

Preliminary conclusion

- Shift from Gorani to Kurdish is historically recent
- It coincides with the fall of Ardalan principality in the 19th Century.

Language shift

- Shift-induced change here refers to (rapid) shift that entails imperfect adult language learning. An example is the shift from Irish to English (happened particularly during the nineteenth century)

Irish English: ***Outside of that, I don't know.***

Irish: ***Taobh amuigh de sin, níl a fhios agam.*** (Hickey 2019)

Scenario model for stability of linguistic features (Nichols 2003)

Table 13.3 Summary of features discussed by Nichols (2003) in terms of a scenario model

<i>Feature</i>	<i>Inherit</i>	<i>Borrow</i>	<i>Substratum</i>	<i>Select</i>
Basic vocabulary	H	L	?	n.a.
Pronouns	H	L	L	Variable
Pronouns in general	H	L	?	n.a.
Resonance in pronouns	H	H	H?	H
Resonance in mama-papa	?	H?	H?	H
Ergativity	L	L	H?	L
Phonetics	H	H	H	Variable
Sound patterns	H	L?	H?	L?
Canonical syllable	H	Variable?	Variable?	Variable?
Front vowel raising	H	H	H	H
Numeral classifiers	Not H	Not H	?	Nil
Gender	Not H	L	?	Nil?
Inclusive–exclusive	H	Appreciable	High?	L
SOV	H	H	H?	H
SVO	H?	Somewhat H	?	?
Verb-initial	L	L	H?	L

H = high probability; L = low probability

- Phonology
- *Vm > Vv/w in Kurdish, but Vm in Gorani

Gorani	SCK	NCK (Mukri, Erbil)	
<i>čam</i>	<i>čāw</i>	<i>čāw</i>	‘eye’
<i>nāmē</i>	<i>nāw</i>	<i>nāw</i>	‘name’

- Phonology
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<i>nāmē</i>	<i>nāw</i>	<i>nāw</i>	‘name’
<i>dam</i>	<i>dam</i>	<i>daw</i>	‘mouth’
<i>nīm</i>	<i>nīm</i>	<i>nīw</i>	‘half’
	<i>am</i>	<i>aw</i>	‘this’

- Phonology

Fortition of /w/

Hawrami

SCK

NCK (Mukri, Erbil)

(ma)-wīn-ū

a-wēn-im

da-bīn-im

‘I see.’

(ma)-wār-o

a-wār-ē

da-bār-ē

‘It rains.’

- Phonology

The realisation of ng as /ŋ/

Hawrami	SCK
---------	-----

daŋ	daŋ	‘voice’
-----	-----	---------

taŋ	taŋ	‘tight’
-----	-----	---------

yāŋza	yāŋza	‘eleven’
-------	-------	----------

- Phonology

The realisation of ng as /ŋ/

Hawrami	SCK	NCK (Mukri, Erbil)	
daŋ	daŋ	dang	‘voice’
taŋ	taŋ	tang	‘tight’
yāŋza	yāŋza	yāzda	‘eleven’

Verb stems

SCK

san-/ sanī

ēr-/ hāwird

žinaf-/ žinaft-

NCK

kiř-/ kiři-

hēn-/ hēnā

bīs-/ bīst-

‘to buy’

‘to bring’

‘listen’

Verb stems

Hawrami

sān-/ sānā-

ār-/ ārd-

ažnīya-/ ažnīyā

SCK

san-/ sanī

ēr-/ hāwird

žinaf-/ žinaft-

NCK

kiř-/ kiřī-

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bīs-/ bīst-

‘to buy’

‘to bring’

‘listen’

Modality verb 'should' (Fr. Il faut), e.g. *ašē bičī* 'You need to go'

Hawrami

SCK

NCK

mi-š-o

a-š-ē

a-b-ē, da-b-ē

Clitic-copula ordering

- (3) CK Erbil/ Shaqlawa
sarmā=**īt-im**
cold=**COP.3SG=1SG**
'I am cold.'

Clitic-copula ordering

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sarmā=**īt-im**
cold=**COP.3SG=1SG**
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- (4) CK Suleimaniya/Sanandaj
sarmā=**m=a**
cold-**1SG=COP.3SG**
'I am cold.'

Clitic-copula ordering

- (3) CK Erbil/ Shaqlawa
sarmā=**īt-im**
hungry=**COP.3SG=1SG**
'I am hungry.'
- (4) CK Suleimaniya/Sanandaj
sarmā=**m=a**
hungry-**1SG=COP.3SG**
'I am hungry.'
- (5) Hawrami
sard-**m=ā**
cold-**1SG=COP.3SG**
'I am cold.'

Bound affix ordering: person markers (Mohammadirad *submitted*)

- (6) CK Mukri
nārd=tān-īn
send.pst=**2PL:A=1PL:O**
'You sent us (away).'

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- (6) CK Mukri
nārd=tān-īn
send.pst=**2PL:A=1PL:O**
‘You sent us (away).’

- (7) CK Jaffi (South of Sanandaj, Iran)
hanārd-īn=tān
send.pst-**1PL:O=2PL:A**
‘You sent us (away).’

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hanārd-īn=tān
send.pst-**1PL:O=2PL:A**
‘You sent us (away).’
- (8) Hawrami
kīyāst-īmē=tā
send.pst-**1PL:O=2PL:A**
‘You sent us (away).’

Inflection on the verb is an area of language which is highly liable to error in Second language learning (cf. Clahsen and Muysken 1996)

Bound affix ordering: person markers (Mohammadirad *submitted*)

- (9) Gorani Qal'eh (near Qurveh)

bard=*mān*=*tān*

take.pst=**1PL:O=2PL:A**

‘You took us (away).’

- (10) CK Sanandaj

bird=*mān*=*tān*

take.pst=**1PL:O=2PL:A**

‘You took us (away).’

In language shift situations abstract features tend to be transferred from the substrate language to the dominant language (cf. Muysken 2010, 273)

Grammatical patterns cannot be borrowed without their ordering properties (Moravcsik 1978: 112).

Particle verbs

(11) CK Mukri

lē=y dā

‘He hit (him).’

pē kanīn

‘to laugh’

lē=y a-xuř-in

‘They shout at him.’

pē=y zānī

‘He learned about it.’

Particle verbs

(11)	CK Mukri	CK Sanandaj	
	<i>lē=y dā</i>	<i>dā=y lē</i>	‘He hit (him).’
	<i>pē kanīn</i>	<i>kanīn pē</i>	‘to laugh’
	<i>lē=y a-xuř-in</i>	<i>a-xuř-in lē</i>	‘They shout at him.’
	<i>pē=y zānī</i>	<i>zānī pē=y</i>	‘He learned about it.’

Particle verbs

(11)	CK Mukri	CK Sanandaj	Hawrami	
	<i>lē=y dā</i>	<i>dā=y lē</i>	<i>dā=š vana</i>	‘He hit (him).’
	<i>pē kanīn</i>	<i>kanīn pē</i>	<i>xuwāy pana</i>	‘to laugh’
	<i>lē=y a-xuř-in</i>	<i>a-xuř-in lē</i>	<i>xuřā=š vana</i>	‘They shout at him.’
	<i>pē=y zānī</i>	<i>zānī pē=y</i>	<i>zānā=š pana</i>	‘He learned about it.’

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	<i>pē=y zānī</i>	<i>zānī pē=y</i>	<i>zānā=š pana</i>	‘He learned about it.’

Light verb complements

(12) Northern CK

ba jiwāb hāt

‘He started to speak.’

ba jē=yān hēšt

‘They left (it) behind.’

ba jē mā

‘It was left behind.’

wa řē a-kaw-ē

‘He sets off.’

Light verb complements

(12)	Northern CK	CK Sanandaj	
	<i>ba jiwāb hāt</i>	<i>hāt=a juwāw</i>	‘He started to speak.’
	<i>ba jē=yān hēšt</i>	<i>hēšt=yān=a jē</i>	‘They left (it) behind.’
	<i>ba jē mā</i>	<i>mā jē</i>	‘It was left behind.’
	<i>wa řē a-kaw-ē</i>	<i>a-kaf-ēt=a řē</i>	‘He sets off.’

Light verb complements

(12)	Northern CK	CK Sanandaj	Hawrami	
	<i>ba jiwāb hāt</i>	<i>hāt=a juwāw</i>	<i>āmā juwāb</i>	‘He started to speak.’
	<i>ba jē=yān hēšt</i>	<i>hēšt=yān=a jē</i>	<i>āst=šā jīyā</i>	‘They left (it) behind.’
	<i>ba jē mā</i>	<i>mā jē</i>	<i>mano jīyā</i>	‘It was left behind.’
	<i>wa řē a-kaw-ē</i>	<i>a-kaf-ēt=a řē</i>	<i>gin-o řā</i>	‘He sets off.’

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Locational copula clauses

(13) NCK

la mā! = im

at home=cop.1sg

‘I am at home.’

Locational copula clauses

(13) NCK

la mā! = im

at home = cop.1sg

‘I am at home.’

(14) SCK

hā = *m = a mā!*

deic = 1sg.cop = drct home

‘I am at home.’

Locational copula clauses

(13) NCK

la mā! = im

at home=cop.1sg

‘I am at home.’

(14) SCK

***hā** = m = a mā!*

deic=1sg.cop=drct home

‘I am at home.’

(15) Hawrami

***īnā** = nē yāna-na*

deic=cop.1sg home-post

‘I am at home.’

Word order profile. The placement of obliques

Addressees of 'say'

e.g. 'I said to my mother'

	n.clauses	Addressee-V	V-Addressee	
CK Mukri	12	100%	0%	(cf. Öpengin 2016)

Word order profile. The placement of obliques

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Hawrami Takht	17	6%	94%	(cf. Mohammadirad <i>in prep</i>)

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Hawrami Takht	17	6%	94%	(cf. Mohammadirad <i>in prep</i>)

This is an instance of shift-induced constructional change (Ross 2019)

The additive Particle meaning ‘too, even’

Hawrami =īč

CK Sanandaj =īč

NCK =īš

Particles

sā

(16) Hawrami

<i>a</i>	<i>čē=č</i>	<i>sā</i>	<i>sar-ě/</i>	<i>duě</i>	<i>sarē</i>
<i>PRSNT</i>	<i>here=ADDwell</i>	<i>CLF-INDF</i>	<i>two</i>	<i>CLF-INDF</i>	
<i>haywān</i>	<i>sara</i>	<i>bəř-ēn-ē=ū/</i>			
<i>animal</i>	<i>head</i>	<i>cut.PRS-PSTC-3PL=and</i>			

Here [at the bride's family] too, they would behead one or two animals.

(17) SCK

<i>min</i>	<i>ba</i>	<i>am</i>	<i>kāwrā.</i>	<i>sā</i>	<i>panā</i>	<i>ba</i>	<i>xwā</i>
<i>1sg</i>	<i>imp.give.2sg</i>	<i>dem.prox</i>	<i>man</i>	<i>well</i>	<i>refuge</i>	<i>to</i>	<i>God</i>

‘Give me to this man. Well, let's take refuge to God.’

Particles

Hawrami

CK Sanandaj

CK Mukri

agarkata

agarkata

agar

‘if’

hatākata

hatākata

hatā

‘until, till’

Lexicon

Kin terms

Hawrami

SCK

lālo, lāla

lāla, (xā!o)

wawī

wayī

bābā

bāwā

bāwažanī

bāwažin

bāwapīyāra

bāwapīyāra

NCK

xā!

‘maternal uncle’

būk

‘bride, daughter in law’

bāpīr

‘grandfather’

ziř-dāyk

‘stepmother’

ziř-bāwk

‘stepfather’

Body parts

gulk, gilκ

kilk

zwān

zwān

tēwa!

tēwa!

lūta

lūt

qāmik

‘finger’

zimān

‘tongue’

nēwčāwān

‘forehead’

kapo

‘nose’

Lexicon

Adjectives

Hawrami

SCK

kawa

kaw

čarma

čarmū, čarmig

barz

barz

ku!

ku!

qāyim

qāyim

NCK

šīn

‘blue’

sipī

‘white’

bilind

‘high’

kurt

‘short’

stūr

‘thick’

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